

Cody Adams

Platform Engineering, DevOps & SRE Leader

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Summary

Platform engineering, DevOps, and site reliability engineering (SRE) leader with 20+ years building and operating infrastructure across startups, growth-stage SaaS, and Fortune 100 enterprises — equally effective as a hands-on, full-stack technical owner and as an engineering executive. Career-long owner of incident and change management, BC/DR, data protection, compliance-as-code, and FinOps/cloud unit-economics practices, defining public-facing SLAs, the SLOs beneath them, and the error budgets that govern change velocity, while driving down mean time to resolution (MTTR) in 99.9%+ SLA environments throughout. Deep expertise across Azure, AWS, Kubernetes, and Infrastructure as Code (IaC), with a track record of leading SOC 2, ISO 27001, FedRAMP, and NIST 800-53 compliance programs, operating HIPAA-, SOX-, and GDPR-regulated platforms, and executing zero-downtime infrastructure transformations at enterprise scale. Consistently recognized by peers and direct reports for pairing that technical range with genuine, individually-invested leadership.

Career Highlights

- Inherited a \$1.8M budget deficit as Director of Platform Engineering at Opala (March 2025) and closed it to positive within the first year, while owning a \$5–7M annual budget and a 10-person organization.
- Grew Ford’s 2-person “skunkworks” lab into a 150-person organization — including Ford’s first offshore production operations — establishing the enterprise’s Next Generation Data Center function.
- Promoted or expanded in scope in every role held, from Data Center Administrator at Plex to Director of Platform Engineering today.
- Full lifecycle, full-stack technical ownership at every role — from architecture through hands-on incident response, including debugging across unfamiliar languages and systems when needed. The IaC libraries, DevOps frameworks, and change and incident processes established at each company have stayed in use after moving on.
- Regularly leads large-scale demos and training presentations; owns skills-matrix design, target behavior frameworks, and tooling/integration architecture across every organization led.
- Systems depth few platform leaders bring to the table: expert-level Windows and Linux administration, including OS clustering and filesystems engineering.
- Early AI adopter: led Hoylu’s initial AI rollout (2024); at Opala — a Coalition for Health AI (CHAI) participant — drives SOC 2/HIPAA-ready AI practices and helped implement a Databricks Genie AI workflow integration and a healthcare AI chatbot application.

Core Skills

- **Cloud & Infrastructure:** Bare-Metal & Private Data Center, VMware/Traditional VM Hosting, Hybrid & Multi-Cloud (Azure, AWS incl. GovCloud), Container Orchestration (HashiCorp Nomad, Kubernetes/AKS), Landing Zone Architecture (DC & Cloud), Infrastructure as Code (Terraform, incl. COTS/Vendor Platforms), High-Availability & Low-Latency Design, Secure-by-Default Architecture (Edge to Enterprise Fleet Scale)
- **Network & Security Engineering:** DNS & Core Infrastructure Services, WAN/LAN Planning & Operations (incl. PBX/Telephony), Cross-Cloud & Multi-Cloud Networking (Peering, Transit Gateways, Interconnects), BGP, VPN, CDN Architecture, Production Firewall Management, Zscaler

(Zero-Trust Access), PKI & Encryption, Blue & Red Team Security Operations, Network & Application Security Engineering

- **Identity & Access Management:** Microsoft Entra ID (Workforce & B2C/External ID), OIDC, SAML, SCIM, SSO/Federation, Zero-Trust IAM
- **Systems Engineering:** Windows & Linux (Expert-Level Administration), OS Clustering, Filesystems Engineering
- **CI/CD & Automation:** Azure DevOps, GitHub Actions, Jenkins, TeamCity, Bamboo, Octopus Deploy, TFS, Docker, Packer, Ansible, Chef, ARM/Azure CLI, GitOps, ChatOps, Automated/Self-Healing Infrastructure
- **Release Engineering & Version Control:** Centralized-to-Distributed VCS Migration (TFVC/SVN → Git), Branching/Merging/Release/Deployment Strategy Design, End-to-End Productionization
- **Developer Experience (DX):** Self-Service Platforms, Developer Tooling & Enablement, Shift-Left Operations — since 2012
- **Security & Compliance:** HIPAA, SOC 2, ISO 27001, SOX 404, FedRAMP, NIST 800-53, CSA CAIQ, GDPR, CMS Interoperability, Compliance Automation (Draata), DevSecOps
- **Governance & Resilience:** Change & Incident Management, BC/DR, Compliance-as-Code, GRC Engineering, Immutable & Secure Infrastructure, Shift-Left DevOps, Customer-Facing Technical & Compliance Audits (Pre- & Post-Sales)
- **Observability & SRE:** ELK Stack, Wazuh SIEM, Grafana, Prometheus, AppDynamics, CloudWatch, CloudTrail, Azure Application Insights, Public-Facing SLA & SLO Definition, Error Budget Management, MTTR Reduction, Incident Response, SRE Practices & On-Call Frameworks
- **AI Enablement:** AI Adoption & Governance (SOC 2/HIPAA-Ready), Databricks Genie AI Workflow Integration, Healthcare AI Applications, CHAI Participation
- **Leadership & Delivery:** Multi-Million \$ Budget Ownership, FinOps & Cloud Unit Economics (COGS Metrics), Org Design & Hiring, Agile/Scrum Coaching (PSM I), ITIL/ITSM, Vendor & Program Management, Board/Executive Reporting, End-to-End Support Model Design (L0 Automation → L1 Helpdesk → Incident/Problem Management → Roadmap), Program Planning (6-Week to 6-Year Horizons)
- **Languages & Scripting:** C, C++, C#, .NET/.NET Core, Java, Kotlin, TypeScript, Go, Python, Bash, PowerShell, custom DSLs, YAML/JSON
- **Application & Data Layer:** Reverse Proxies & Web Servers, SQL & NoSQL Databases, Databricks, Message Bus/Queueing, Caching Systems

Professional Experience

Director of Platform Engineering

Opala — Seattle, WA (Remote) | March 2025 – Present

- Expanded role from Cloud DevOps and IT Operations to also own Security Engineering and Security Operations — redesigning the org chart to lead a multi-disciplinary organization spanning cloud infrastructure, DevOps, SRE, cybersecurity, audit/compliance, and corporate IT.
- Established SRE practices, observability standards, and incident response frameworks for a HIPAA-regulated, CMS interoperability-mandated healthcare platform; define the public-facing SLA and the SLOs beneath it, and lead change decisions weighed against remaining error budget.
- Drive multi-cloud (Azure/AWS) architecture decisions with security and compliance as first-class design constraints.
- Deploy to production daily via IaC and GitHub Actions; built GitHub OIDC federation and centralized DevSecOps policy enforcement across all environments.
- Delivered 30+ reusable Infrastructure-as-Code modules including Databricks IaC and extensive Python-based access audits; created DevSecOps pipelines and the platform's initial Docker build pipelines.

- Own cybersecurity posture, audit readiness, and the HIPAA and SOC 2 compliance programs — including Drata compliance automation with Azure and AWS integrations — positioning compliance as a business enabler rather than a checkbox exercise.
- Hands-on owner of enterprise DNS, firewalls, VPNs, Zscaler zero-trust access, identity lifecycle, endpoint security, developer tooling, and day-to-day IT operations including direct client support.
- Drive Opala's AI adoption — SOC 2/HIPAA-ready practices, Coalition for Health AI (CHAI) participation, and key implementation of a Databricks Genie AI workflow integration and a healthcare AI chatbot application.

Director of DevOps *(promoted from Senior DevOps Engineer)*

Hoylu — Kirkland, WA | August 2020 – February 2025

- Hoylu's first dedicated DevOps/Platform Engineering hire; retained and expanded scope through multiple company-wide workforce reductions.
- Owned the full platform engineering function for a global SaaS collaboration platform serving enterprise and government customers; managed a team of 8 (DevOps and backend engineers) with unified DevSecOps/SRE ownership.
- Reported directly to the VP of Engineering and CEO; designed customer usage-based COGS metrics that gave the board real-time visibility into cloud unit economics.
- Led cloud cost optimization initiatives that materially reduced operational spend while maintaining platform reliability and growth capacity.
- Led ISO/IEC 27001 certification end-to-end (certified to :2013 in 2021, transitioned to :2022 in 2024) and architected a fully customized SaaS deployment in AWS GovCloud — leading FedRAMP Moderate compliance activities — unlocking enterprise and government customer acquisition.
- Designed a zero-trust, cloud-native platform on the HashiCorp stack (Consul, Nomad, Terraform, Vault) with an automated mutual-TLS service mesh and Wazuh SIEM; self-healing, automated infrastructure supported a public SLA without headcount growth.
- Built 25+ reusable Infrastructure-as-Code modules (primarily Bash and Azure CLI), embedded DAST/SAST and penetration testing into the SDLC, and led Hoylu's initial AI rollout (2024).

DevOps Practice Manager / Cloud Architect

Coretek Services — Farmington, MI | May 2019 – August 2020

- Built Coretek's DevOps consulting practice from zero, delivering cross-industry enterprise and mid-market engagements from initial economic assessment (dozens delivered) through production delivery.
- Led cloud migrations and Azure foundation deployments aligned to the Azure Well-Architected Framework, plus Azure Serverless and Azure DevOps migration engagements.
- Defined and launched the DevOps service catalog (containerization, CI/CD, IaC) using Azure DevOps, AKS, and Terraform; built and trained cross-functional delivery teams spanning staff, clients, and vendors.

DevOps Platform Manager

Delta Dental of Michigan — Okemos, MI | November 2018 – May 2019

- Led development of a Kubernetes-based, metal-up enterprise application hosting platform in a private data center — high availability with no cloud abstraction layer — with direct CTO-level engagement.
- Architected platform-level BC/DR so application teams inherited business continuity and disaster recovery posture by default; maintained federal compliance requirements across the platform.
- Modernized ITSM processes (Change, Incident, Problem Management) and integrated observability tooling (ELK, AppDynamics), reducing central IT dependency through developer self-service.

Ford Motor Company — Dearborn, MI (3 years 3 months)

DevOps Principal Architect – Data Center of the Future | March 2017 – November 2018

- Lead architect and agile coach across a concurrent Platform-as-a-Service portfolio, influencing hundreds of engineers with developer experience as a first-class design concern.
- Replaced foundational infrastructure of a live global operation in real time with zero downtime, embedding compliance and security controls that had not previously existed.
- Delivered platforms including Kubernetes (Containers as a Service), Pivotal Cloud Foundry, SQL Server PaaS, VMware vRealize Operations, IBM API Connect, and F5 iWorkflow network orchestration.
- Established new release engineering practices for IT Operations and trained the Release Manager role into existence.
- Displaced incumbent teams and legacy platforms when the solutions delivered outperformed them, most notably replacing Ford's enterprise Active Directory environment.

Cloud and DevOps Consultant | September 2015 – March 2017

- Defined Ford's Data Center of the Future architecture vision across compute, storage, network, cloud, big data, and hosting, with compliance as a first-class design requirement where none had previously existed.
- Designed Ford's first two purpose-built enterprise data centers — from the rack, power, and cooling level up — and presented the strategy directly to the CIO.
- Established and operated the Next Generation Lab, a production-grade VMware SDDC private cloud proving ground for new platform capabilities, with full asset, service delivery, and vendor management ownership.
- Collaborated directly with Chef co-founder Adam Jacob, HashiCorp co-founder Armon Dadgar, and HashiCorp's Seth Vargo on core Infrastructure-as-Code tooling and DevOps workflow design as part of Ford's IaC and automation strategy.

DevOps Team Lead (*promoted from Data Center Administrator*)

Plex Systems, Inc. — Auburn Hills, MI | March 2012 – September 2015

- Full-lifecycle infrastructure ownership in a 24/7, SOX 404-compliant, 99.9% public-SLA SaaS environment — managing change against the ~43-minute monthly error budget it allows.
- Built the company's initial CI/CD, IaC, and ChatOps toolchain, driving deployment frequency from periodic to continuous, including blue/green and mid-day production deployments.
- Reduced VM build time by 90% through automation, cutting SOX 404 audit burden in the process — earning the 2014 Q3 "Plex Impact" Innovation Award.
- Primary on-call 24/7/365 for production: rapid response, incident commander, and problem report owner using the 8D methodology.

Earlier Career

Brose North America — Systems Administrator | Auburn Hills, MI | July 2008 – April 2012

- Grew a regional IT role into North American leadership scope, establishing data-driven ITIL practices.
- Delivered a 20% local IT headcount reduction through automation.

Prior: ~3 years of self-employed IT work and PC technician roles (2005–2008).

Certifications & Education

Certifications: Professional Scrum Master I (PSM I), 2017 | Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900), 2019 | Scrum Fundamentals Certified. **Education:** B.S., Computer Science, University of Michigan–Flint.